

Building a portfolio website strategy ▾



This is my strategy to build my portfolio website, so guide me accordingly and also teaching me about what we are doing, why and how accordingly. Review this plan and start with phase 1

I've reviewed your full plan — it's well-structured. Let's dive into Phase 1 properly.

Before I ask you anything, here's what Phase 1 actually is and why it matters:

Why Phase 1 exists: Every visual decision later — your color choices, font style, layout vibe — needs to feel *consistent*. That consistency is what makes a portfolio look professional vs. "student project." Phase 1 locks in your brand identity so you're not making random style decisions during development.

What we'll define today:

- Your design style (dark/light/minimal/bold)
- Color palette (2-3 colors)
- Typography (heading font + body font)
- The "feeling" your site gives off in 5 seconds
- Your primary goal for each visitor

Let's start with the most important question — **who's visiting your site and what should they feel?**

Q: What's the primary goal of your portfolio right now?

A: Both internships + freelance

Q: What design vibe feels most 'you'?

A: Dark + minimal + techy (think VS Code aesthetic)

Q: Which area do you want your portfolio to emphasize most?

A: A balanced mix of everything

Good answers — these three decisions already tell me a lot. Let me explain what they mean before we go deeper.

What your answers mean for the site:

Dark + minimal + techy means your site will have a dark background (near-black, not pure black), clean typography, subtle glows or gradients, and breathing room — no clutter. This style says *"I write clean code"* before you've said a word.

Both internships + freelance means two types of people will land on your site — a recruiter at a tech company, and a small business owner looking for a developer. Your copy and project descriptions need to speak to both. Doable, but we'll be intentional about it.

Balanced mix means your projects section will be organized by category (Web Dev / AI / Other) rather than dumping everything in a grid.

Now let's nail your **color palette**. This is the single most impactful visual decision.

For dark + minimal + techy, the formula is:

- **Base:** near-black background (like or)
- **Accent:** one signature color that appears on CTAs, hover states, and highlights
- **Secondary:** a muted tone for subtext, borders, and cards

Q: Pick your signature accent color — this will be your brand color everywhere

A: Electric blue / cyan () — most popular for tech portfolios

Q: For your name/logo on the site, what feels right?

A: Just my name in a clean font (text-based)

Perfect choices. Cyan on dark is a classic for a reason — it reads as sharp and technical without trying too hard. And text-based names are actually more memorable than most logo attempts at this stage.

Let me now show you exactly what your brand system looks like before we move to typography.

COLOR PALETTE

Base background #0d0d0d	Accent — cyan #00d4ff	Card surface #1a1a1a	Muted / subtext #888888
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TYPOGRAPHY

Headings Inter / Space Grotesk Hello, I'm Manya	Body text Inter Regular CS student building things at the intersection of web and AI.	Code / tags JetBrains Mono const role = "developer"
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LIVE PREVIEW — HERO SECTION

Manya Chourasiya

AboutProjectsSkillsContact

// CS Student • Developer • Builder

Hi, I'm Manya Chourasiya

B.Tech Computer Science • Web Dev • AI

View Projects

Download CV

That's your brand system. What you're looking at is exactly how your hero section will feel — dark, clean, technical, with cyan as the only color doing any work.

Why these specific choices:

The #0d0d0d background is not pure black — pure black (#000000) looks harsh and flat. This near-black gives the cyan accent room to breathe. The #1a1a1a card surface creates a subtle layering effect so cards feel lifted without needing shadows. Cyan is used only on things you want the eye to land on: your name highlight, buttons, and active states — everywhere else is white or muted gray.

For fonts, **Space Grotesk** for headings (it has a slightly geometric, techy edge) and **Inter** for body (the most readable UI font ever made). **JetBrains Mono** for any code snippets or tags — this signals "I actually code" immediately.

Phase 1 is now 80% done. One last thing to lock in before we move to Phase 2:

Q: How should your name appear in the navbar / browser tab?

A: Manya Chourasiya (full name, professional)

Q: What animation style do you want on the site?

A: Fade-in sections on scroll (subtle, elegant)

Perfect. Both of these are the right calls, honestly.

Full name in the navbar is more professional and searchable — when a recruiter screenshots your site or saves the tab, they see your full name, not a nickname. Fade-in on scroll is the smartest animation choice too — it makes the site feel alive without ever distracting from your content. Particle backgrounds and typing animations are overused and actually slow sites down.

Phase 1 is complete. Let me give you your official brand brief — this is the document every Phase 2–7 decision will refer back to.

Phase 1 — brand brief

✓ Locked in

NAME ON SITE

Manya Chourasiya

Full name — navbar + browser tab

PRIMARY GOAL

Internships + Freelance

Dual audience — recruiters & clients

FOCUS AREA

Balanced mix

Web Dev · AI · Other — all shown

DESIGN VIBE

Dark · Minimal · Techy

VS Code-style aesthetic

ANIMATION STYLE

Fade-in on scroll

Subtle, elegant — never distracting

COLOR PALETTE

BACKGROUND

#0d0d0d

Near-black base

ACCENT

#00d4ff

Electric cyan — brand color

CARD SURFACE

#1a1a1a

Elevated layer

MUTED TEXT

#888888

Subtext, borders

TYPOGRAPHY

HEADINGS

Space Grotesk

Geometric, techy character

BODY

Inter

Most readable UI font

CODE / TAGS

JetBrains Mono

Signals real developer

Ready for Phase 2 — Architecture & Structure

Sitemap · all sections · content inventory · what goes where

Start Phase 2 ↗

That's your complete Phase 1 brand brief — save or screenshot this, because you'll refer back to it constantly during development.

What you just accomplished: Every visual decision for your site is now made. When you're in Phase 4 writing CSS and someone asks "what color should this button be?" — you already know. When you're picking a font on Google Fonts — already decided. This is exactly why Phase 1 exists. No second-guessing later.

One quick thing to understand about your dual audience — since you picked both internships and freelance, here's how we handle it without confusing either visitor. Your hero section speaks to both ("I build web apps and AI tools"), your Projects section will have category tags so a recruiter can filter by tech and a freelance client can filter by outcome. One site, two audiences, no compromise. We'll design this properly in Phase 2.

Hit **Start Phase 2** in the card above, or just say "let's go" and we'll move into building your sitemap and content structure.

Let's start Phase 2

Phase 2 is where we become architects, not coders. Think of this exactly like drawing the blueprint of a house — you wouldn't start laying bricks without knowing where the walls go.

What we're doing in Phase 2:

- Decide every page and section your site has
- Define what content lives in each section
- Decide the *order* sections appear (this affects how recruiters read your story)
- Create a content inventory you'll fill in with your real details

Why order matters: A recruiter spends 15–30 seconds on a portfolio. The section order is your narrative — Hero grabs them, About gives context, Skills proves capability, Projects closes the deal. Get the order wrong and you lose them before they see your best work.

First, let me understand what you actually have to show right now.

Q: How many projects do you have that are worth showing right now?

A: 3–4 projects

Q: What do you currently have to show as experience? (Select all that apply)

A: College coursework / academics, Personal projects, Internship or job (even informal), Hackathon participation

Q: Do you have a resume ready right now?

A: Yes but it needs work

Great — you have more than enough to build a strong v1. 3-4 projects, real experience, hackathon participation, and a resume in progress. That's a solid foundation.

Let me now design your sitemap and section order based exactly on what you have.

SINGLE-PAGE ARCHITECTURE — SECTION ORDER

01 **Hero**

Name, role, 1-line tagline, two CTAs (View Projects + Download CV). First thing every visitor sees — must communicate your value in 5 seconds.

Hook

02 **About**

3–4 sentence story: who you are, what you build, what drives you. Photo optional. Not a bio — a pitch to the right visitor.

Hook

03 **Skills**

Grouped by category: Languages, Frameworks, Tools, AI/ML. Visual tags, not progress bars. Progress bars are subjective and waste space.

Proof

04 **Projects**

3–4 cards with category filter (Web Dev / AI / All). Each card: name, 1-line what it does, tech stack tags, GitHub + Live Demo links.

Proof

05 **Experience**

Timeline layout. Internship, hackathons, and college coursework that is relevant. Even informal experience counts — include it.

Trust

06 **Certifications**

Small cards: cert name, issuer, year. Link to verification. Only show certs that are recognisable or relevant — quality over quantity.

Trust

07 **Achievements**

Hackathon results, academic awards, anything quantifiable. Even "Top 20 out of 200 teams" is worth showing. Numbers make this real.

Trust

08 **Resume**

Single prominent download button. Keep the PDF updated — a stale resume is worse than no resume. Also embed a preview so they can scan without downloading.

Action

09 **Contact**

Simple form (name, email, message) via EmailJS — no backend needed. Also show LinkedIn and GitHub icons.
Make it frictionless to reach you.

Action

RECRUITER READING PATTERN

Hook → grabs attention in 5 seconds · **Proof** → shows you can actually build things · **Trust** → validates with experience and credentials · **Action** → converts them into a message or download

YOUR CONTENT INVENTORY

3-4
Projects ready

✓
Internship experience

✓
Hackathon participation

WIP
Resume (needs polish)

Ready for content inventory
Fill in your real projects, skills, and experience details

Fill content inventory ↗